Project Title: My Self-Advocacy, Workplace Readiness, & Family Advocacy Plan

OBJECTIVE:
Students will develop a personalized plan to enhance their self-advocacy skills while preparing for success in the workplace, job searching, balancing family responsibilities, and advocating for their children and families in schools and the community.

STEPS:

1. **Self-Reflection Journal**
   - Write about a challenge they face balancing home life, job responsibilities, job searching, and family needs.
   - Identify specific areas where self-advocacy could help, such as requesting flexible work arrangements, negotiating salary, accessing workplace benefits, or advocating for their children's education and well-being.
2. **Research & Resources**
   - Find at least three resources (job search assistance programs, workplace policies, school programs, community services, or parent support groups).
   - Summarize how each resource can support workplace readiness, career success, and family well-being.
3. **Communication Strategy**
   - Draft an email or script for a conversation with an employer, hiring manager, teacher, school administrator, or community organization to request support, accommodations, or services.
   - Peer review and practice delivering the request.
4. **Job Search & Workplace Readiness**
   - Identify job search challenges (e.g., flexible work schedules, childcare needs, skill development).
   - Develop a strategy for advocating for their needs in resumes, cover letters, and interviews.
   - Research companies that support working parents and review employee benefits such as childcare assistance or remote work options.
   - Learn about professional etiquette, workplace expectations, and strategies for career advancement.
5. **Advocating for Children & Family in Schools & the Community**
   - Identify challenges their children face in school (e.g., learning support, special education, extracurricular access).
   - Learn how to communicate effectively with teachers and school administrators.
   - Explore ways to get involved in community programs that support parents and families.
   - Research laws and policies that protect parents' and children's rights in education and community resources.
6. **Advocacy Action Plan**
   - Outline 3-5 concrete steps they will take in the next month to improve their self-advocacy, workplace readiness, and family advocacy.
7. **Presentation or Reflection**
   - Share key takeaways in a brief written reflection or informal discussion.
   - Discuss how self-advocacy in work, school, and community settings will impact their personal and professional growth.

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